officers and armed forces besides empowering an interning authority to intern a suspect until the continuation of action in aid of the civil power by the armed forces. The armed forces have also been empowered to occupy any property with the approval of the federal or the provincial government.

Contrary to the provisions of *Qanun-i-Shahadat* (Evidence Act), these regulations provide that a statement or deposition by any member of the armed forces, or any officer authorised on his behalf, shall be sufficient for convicting an accused.

Similarly, all evidences, information and material collected, received and prepared by the interning authority or its officials shall be admissible in evidence and shall be deemed sufficient to prove the facts in issue.

Furthermore, the regulations gave a set of offences, which were punishable with the death penalty or imprisonment for life or up to ten years along with fine and forfeiture of property.

Most of these offences have already been covered in the Anti-Terrorism Act, 1997.

These laws define 'action in aid of civil power' as a series of measures that involve the mobilisation of armed forces, in aid of civil power or their requisition by the federal government, including measures such as armed action, mobilisation and stationing, until they are withdrawn by the written order of the government. Furthermore, 'defined area' refers to the area notified by the federal government (in the case of FATA) and the provincial government (in the case of PATA), in which action in aid of civil power is being conducted to secure the territory or to ensure peace in any place where armed forces have been requisitioned.

The regulations authorised the federal and provincial governments or any person authorised by it to act as interning authority having the powers to intern a person. The interning authority is empowered to intern any person, even if he is not in the defined area, who may obstruct actions in aid of civil power in any manner whatsoever; or if not restrained or incapacitated through interment shall strengthen the miscreant's ability to resist the armed forces or any law enforcement agency; or by any action or attempt may cause a threat to the solidarity, integrity or security of Pakistan; or has committed or is likely to commit any offence under the regulation so that the said person shall not be able to commit or plan to commit any offence during the actions in aid of civil power.